

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Math	Algebra	Linear equations in two variables	Medium

Question

Line p is defined by $2y + 18x = 9$. Line r is perpendicular to line p in the xy -plane. What is the slope of line r ?

Answer

- A. -9
- B. $-\frac{1}{9}$
- C. $\frac{1}{9}$
- D. 9

Correct Answer: C

Rationale

Choice C is correct. It’s given that line r is perpendicular to line p in the xy -plane. This means that the slope of line r is the negative reciprocal of the slope of line p . If the equation for line p is rewritten in slope-intercept form $y = mx + b$, where m and b are constants, then m is the slope of the line and $(0, b)$ is its y -intercept. Subtracting $18x$ from both sides of the equation $2y + 18x = 9$ yields $2y = -18x + 9$. Dividing both sides of this equation by 2 yields $y = -9x + \frac{9}{2}$. It follows that the slope of line p is -9 . The negative reciprocal of a number is -1 divided by the number. Therefore, the negative reciprocal of -9 is $\frac{-1}{-9}$, or $\frac{1}{9}$. Thus, the slope of line r is $\frac{1}{9}$.

Choice A is incorrect. This is the slope of line p , not line r .

Choice B is incorrect. This is the reciprocal, not the negative reciprocal, of the slope of line p .

Choice D is incorrect. This is the negative, not the negative reciprocal, of the slope of line p .